

Scar Camouflage & Cosmetic Tattooing

Aftercare + Expectations

It is completely normal to feel a bit anxious during the initial healing phases of your cosmetic tattoo. The color will change, the skin will flake, and it may look darker than you anticipated before it softens. This guide will walk you through exactly what to expect and how to protect your investment.

The Healing Timeline

Your skin will go through several phases as it heals. Please do not panic if the tattoo appears heavy or dark at first — this is entirely normal and just part of the process. It will take **4 to 5 weeks** for the area to fully heal beneath the surface.

Days 1-2	The tattoo will appear darker, bolder, and sharply defined . You may feel a "sunburned" sensation with minimal swelling. As exfoliation begins, excess pigment surrounding the tattoo will flake away, resulting in a thinner appearance.
Day 3	The area will start to itch and appear thicker in texture as natural exfoliation kicks in. Do not exfoliate or pick.
Day 4	The skin begins to flake and peel from the outside edges first. The color may seem to "disappear" (especially for brows or lips), but it will return as the skin fully heals.
Day 5	The color finishes flaking off. It will appear softer and greyer (for brows/camouflage) or frosty (for lips). The true color will clarify over the next 8 weeks. Expect 25%–40% of the pigment to fade during the first 5–10 days.

Immediate Aftercare Instructions

Strict adherence to these rules is crucial for proper healing and pigment retention.

🚫 Do Not Pick

Never pick, scratch, or disturb the camouflage/pigmented area. If protective scabs form, it is highly important they stay on naturally during the healing process.

💧 Ointment Application

Apply a thin layer of the provided ointment **2 to 3 times per day** for the first 5 days. Always apply the ointment right before bathing or showering to protect the area from water.

💧 Save Your Ointment

Do not throw out your aftercare ointment — you will need the remainder for your touch-up appointment.

🩹 Tegaderm Bandages

If you leave with a Tegaderm bandage, you can safely leave it on for **up to one week**. Do not participate in water activities while wearing it.

✨ Cicaplast / Silicone

Start using silicone products after the **5 to 7-day mark**. Deeply massage the product into the area morning and night until the container is empty for the best results.

What to Avoid

First 5 Days

- Soap, shampoo, cleansers, and cosmetics on the pigmented site
- Saunas, steam rooms, hot baths, and hot yoga
- Anything causing excessive sweating

First 2 Weeks

- Swimming in chlorinated pools

First 6 Weeks

- Direct sun exposure
- Sun tanning beds

📄 ⚠️ Important Swelling & Allergy Notice

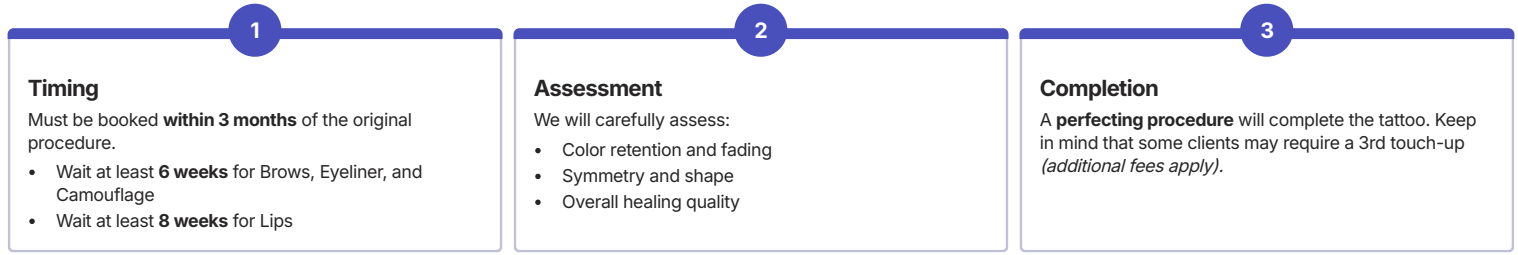
Although rare, excessive swelling or an allergic reaction may occur. If excessive swelling occurs, please **consult your doctor immediately**. If any allergic reaction causes **difficulty breathing and/or severe swelling**, call 911 or go to the **Emergency Room immediately**.

Your Path to the Best Results

Healing is a journey, not an event. Following these long-term guidelines ensures your investment stays beautiful and your results last as long as possible.

The Follow-Up Appointment

Once your tattoo has completely healed, any necessary changes or additions will be made at your follow-up appointment.



Long-Term Care & Fading Factors

Pigments are **iron-oxide based**, meaning your body will safely and slowly absorb them over time. Expect your tattoo to slowly fade over **1 to 3 years** (or roughly **6 months** for clients with oily skin).

Sun Protection

Once completely healed, use a **high-quality SPF daily** on the tattooed area. Sun exposure is the fastest way to fade your tattoo.

Skincare & Spa Treatments

Large pores, oily skin, anti-aging creams, Retinol products, and frequent sweating all contribute to faster fading. Be extremely careful when getting **chemical peels, microdermabrasion**, or using active skincare around the camouflage area. Clients with these factors often require a color boost every **6 to 12 months**.

Anemia

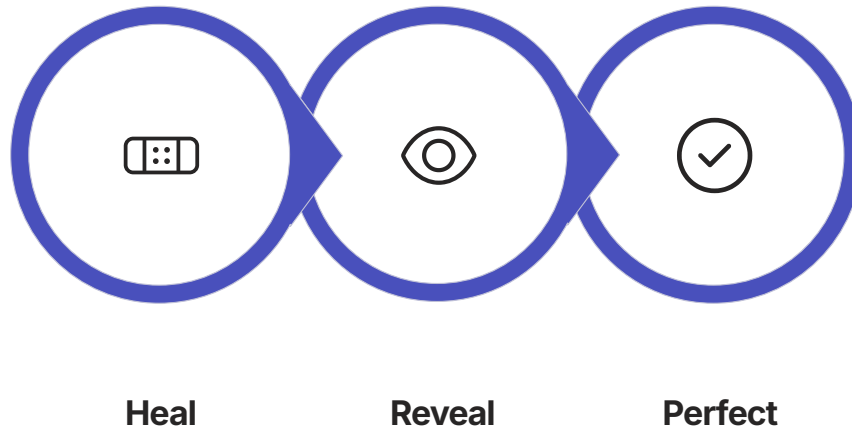
Clients who are anemic will process and fade the iron-oxide pigments much faster than other clients.

Medical Procedures

If you are planning an **MRI, chemical peel**, or other medical procedure, inform the technician that you have an iron-oxide cosmetic tattoo.

Laser Treatments

If you plan to have laser resurfacing or laser hair removal after healing, inform the laser technician. Laser procedures may **darken, lighten, or severely discolor** the tattooed area. Continue at your own discretion.



Every client heals differently — trust the process and follow each phase carefully for the most beautiful outcome.

Please remember that cosmetic tattooing is an **art, not an exact science**. There are no implied or written guarantees. Every client heals differently depending on their unique skin type, skin regeneration rate, and adherence to correct aftercare. It is incredibly important to follow all recommendations so you can enjoy the **best possible result!**

5

Days of Active Aftercare

Apply ointment and protect the area diligently for the first 5 days.

8

Weeks to True Color

The final, true color clarifies fully within 8 weeks post-procedure.

3

Month Follow-Up Window

Book your touch-up appointment within 3 months of your original session.

3yr

Longevity of Results

With proper care, your cosmetic tattoo can last 1 to 3 years beautifully.